

MODULE 20 · DOMAIN 4 - BILLING, PRICING, AND SUPPORT

Support, Partners and Resources

Which plan, which partner, and where the answers live.

DOMAIN 4 of 4 EXAM WEIGHT 12% MODULE 20 of 26

Two things separate the tiers: **how fast AWS answers**, and **whether you get a named person**.

The four paid tiers

PLAN	WHAT IT ADDS
Basic	Free. Documentation, re:Post, Health Dashboard, core Trusted Advisor checks
Developer	Business-hours email support. One contact. No TAM
Business	24/7 phone, email and chat. Full Trusted Advisor. No TAM
Enterprise On-Ramp	24/7, faster response, a pool of Technical Account Managers
Enterprise	24/7, fastest response, a designated Technical Account Manager

ON THE EXAM

Basic is free but includes no technical support cases at all. That surprises people and it is examinable.

Response times

SEVERITY	DEVELOPER	BUSINESS	ENTERPRISE
General guidance	24 hours	24 hours	24 hours
System impaired	12 hours	12 hours	12 hours
Production impaired	not covered	4 hours	4 hours
Production down	not covered	1 hour	1 hour
Business-critical down	not covered	not covered	15 minutes

ON THE EXAM

Business-critical system down is the phrase that means Enterprise. Enterprise On-Ramp gives 30 minutes for the same severity.

Business or Enterprise?

AWS BUSINESS SUPPORT

Round the clock, no named contact

- 24/7 phone, email and chat access
- One hour response for production down
- Full set of Trusted Advisor checks
- Unlimited contacts can open cases

AWS ENTERPRISE SUPPORT

A named person and the fastest response

- Designated Technical Account Manager
- 15 minute response for business-critical down
- Trusted Advisor Priority and Well-Architected reviews
- Concierge support for billing questions

THE TIEBREAKER

A designated Technical Account Manager is the single clearest signal for Enterprise. Business has never included one.

The Technical Account Manager

- ◆ **A named AWS employee who knows your environment** and acts as your primary technical point of contact.
- ◆ They provide proactive guidance, architectural review and help planning for events such as a product launch.
- ◆ **A designated TAM appears only at Enterprise.** Enterprise On-Ramp gives access to a pool, not a named individual.
- ◆ Basic, Developer and Business include no TAM in any form.
- ◆ If a scenario mentions a dedicated or designated technical contact, the answer is Enterprise Support.

ON THE EXAM

Designated means Enterprise. A pool means Enterprise On-Ramp. No TAM at all means Business or below.

What each tier unlocks elsewhere

- ◆ **Trusted Advisor:** core checks on every account; the full set requires Business or above.
- ◆ **Trusted Advisor Priority** requires Enterprise Support.
- ◆ **The AWS Shield Response Team** requires Business or Enterprise, even if you pay for Shield Advanced.
- ◆ AWS Well-Architected reviews with an AWS expert come with Enterprise.
- ◆ The AWS Support API for opening cases programmatically requires Business or above.

ON THE EXAM

Shield Advanced alone does not get you the Shield Response Team. You also need a Business or Enterprise support plan.

The lineup is being replaced

- ◆ **Announced 2 December 2025: Developer, Business and Enterprise On-Ramp all retire on 1 January 2027.**
- ◆ **Business Support+** replaces Developer and Business, from \$29 a month, with 30-minute critical response.
- ◆ Enterprise Support continues, with its minimum reduced from \$15,000 to \$5,000 a month.
- ◆ A new top tier, Unified Operations, starts at \$50,000 a month.
- ◆ **On the exam, answer with the old four names.** The question pool has not been rewritten.

ON THE EXAM

The mapping from requirement to tier is unchanged. Only the labels move. Module 22 covers this properly.

The AWS Partner Network

- ◆ **Consulting partners** are firms that design, build and manage AWS environments for customers.
- ◆ **Technology partners** are independent software vendors whose products run on or integrate with AWS.
- ◆ Partners are certified by AWS and hold competencies in specific areas such as security or migration.
- ◆ **AWS Professional Services** is AWS's own consulting organisation, distinct from partners.
- ◆ Solutions architects assigned to your account provide architectural guidance at no additional charge.

ON THE EXAM

A third party doing the work means a consulting partner. AWS doing the work means AWS Professional Services.

AWS Marketplace

- ◆ **A digital catalogue of third-party software** that runs on AWS, sold by independent vendors.
- ◆ Software can be deployed with a few clicks, often as a pre-configured Amazon Machine Image.
- ◆ **Charges appear on your AWS bill**, so there is no separate procurement process for each vendor.
- ◆ The classic scenario is needing an EC2 instance with a third-party firewall or security tool pre-installed.
- ◆ Do not confuse it with AWS Service Catalog, which lists your own approved internal products.

ON THE EXAM

Buying third-party software means Marketplace. Publishing your own approved templates means Service Catalog.

Where the answers live

- ◆ **AWS re:Post** is the community question and answer service, replacing the old AWS Forums.
- ◆ **The AWS Knowledge Center** holds answers to frequently asked technical questions.
- ◆ **AWS Prescriptive Guidance** publishes patterns, strategies and migration playbooks.
- ◆ Whitepapers and documentation are free to everyone, including Basic Support accounts.
- ◆ AWS Trust and Safety is where you report abuse originating from AWS resources.

ON THE EXAM

All of these are available on Basic Support. A question about free guidance rarely needs a paid plan.

Reverse lookup

IF THE SCENARIO SAYS	THE ANSWER IS
Designated Technical Account Manager	AWS Enterprise Support
Business-critical system down, 15 minute response	AWS Enterprise Support
24/7 phone support, no named contact needed	AWS Business Support
Business hours email only, non-production	AWS Developer Support
Documentation and community answers at no cost	AWS Basic Support
A third-party firewall pre-installed on EC2	AWS Marketplace
A partner firm to run the migration for us	AWS Partner Network consulting partner

ON THE EXAM

Seven phrasings covering nearly every question in this module. The first two both point at Enterprise.

A company runs its main revenue-generating platform on AWS. It requires a fifteen-minute response if that platform goes down, wants a named AWS contact who understands its architecture, and wants an AWS expert to run a Well-Architected review each year. Cost is not the primary concern.

Which support plan meets these requirements?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ A AWS Developer Support | ☐ B AWS Business Support |
| ☐ C AWS Enterprise On-Ramp | ☐ D AWS Enterprise Support |

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which support plan meets these requirements?

- A

AWS Developer Support
Business hours only and no production severities at all. It fails on every one of the three requirements.
- B

AWS Business Support
24/7 with one hour response for production down, but no TAM and no 15 minute severity.
- C

AWS Enterprise On-Ramp
Close. It gives a pool of TAMs and thirty minute response, not a named contact or fifteen minutes.
- D

AWS Enterprise Support
Fifteen minute business-critical response, a designated TAM, and Well-Architected reviews with an AWS expert.

THE SIGNAL

Three requirements, and only Enterprise satisfies all three. Enterprise On-Ramp satisfies weaker versions of two.

A startup runs only development and test workloads on AWS. It has no production systems. It wants to be able to open technical support cases and receive guidance during working hours, at the lowest possible cost.

Nobody needs to be reachable overnight.

Which support plan should the startup choose?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ A AWS Basic Support | ☐ B AWS Developer Support |
| ☐ C AWS Business Support | ☐ D AWS Enterprise Support |

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which support plan should the startup choose?

- A

AWS Basic Support
The trap. Basic is cheapest but includes no technical support cases at all, only documentation and community help.
- B

AWS Developer Support
The cheapest plan that allows technical support cases, during business hours, which is exactly what is described.
- C

AWS Business Support
Adds 24/7 access the startup explicitly does not need, at a higher price.
- D

AWS Enterprise Support
Enormously more than required for development and test workloads.

THE SIGNAL

Basic includes no technical support cases. The moment a scenario needs to open a case, Basic is eliminated.

A company already subscribes to AWS Shield Advanced for its public web application. During a large denial of service attack, it tries to contact the AWS Shield Response Team for help and finds it cannot open the case.

The company is on AWS Developer Support.

Why can the company not reach the Shield Response Team?

- ☐ A The Shield Response Team requires Business or Enterprise Support
- ☐ B Shield Advanced does not include the Shield Response Team
- ☐ C The Shield Response Team only handles attacks on CloudFront
- ☐ D Developer Support has no phone access, so the case must be raised by email

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why can the company not reach the Shield Response Team?

- A

 The Shield Response Team requires Business or Enterprise Support
Shield Advanced grants the entitlement, but reaching the team also requires a Business or Enterprise plan.
- B

 Shield Advanced does not include the Shield Response Team
It does. The subscription is not the blocker; the support plan is.
- C

 The Shield Response Team only handles attacks on CloudFront
Invented restriction. Shield Advanced protects several resource types, not only CloudFront.
- D

 Developer Support has no phone access, so the case must be raised by email
True about Developer Support, but it is not why the Shield case cannot be opened.

THE SIGNAL

Two separate purchases are needed. Paying for Shield Advanced does not by itself buy the support tier it depends on.

A company wants to deploy a commercial network firewall appliance from a well-known security vendor onto an EC2 instance, with the software already installed and licensed. It does not want to install and configure the software itself.

Separately, it wants an external firm with proven AWS expertise to run its upcoming migration.

Which two should the company use? (Choose two.)

- ☐ A AWS Marketplace
- ☐ B AWS Service Catalog
- ☐ C An AWS Partner Network consulting partner
- ☐ D AWS Professional Services
- ☐ E AWS Enterprise Support

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two should the company use? (Choose two.)

- A

AWS Marketplace
Third-party software sold as pre-configured images, deployed in a few clicks and billed through AWS.
- B

AWS Service Catalog
Lists a company's own approved internal products. It does not sell third-party commercial software.
- C

An AWS Partner Network consulting partner
An external firm certified by AWS that designs and delivers migrations. Exactly the second requirement.
- D

AWS Professional Services
Genuinely capable, but it is AWS's own team rather than the external firm the scenario asks for.
- E

AWS Enterprise Support
Provides a TAM and fast response, but does not deliver a migration or sell vendor software.

THE SIGNAL

External firm is the word separating APN partners from AWS Professional Services. Both do the work; only one is external.

What to carry out of this module

- ◆ **A designated Technical Account Manager means Enterprise.** It is the single clearest signal in this domain.
- ◆ Fifteen minutes means Enterprise. Thirty minutes means Enterprise On-Ramp. One hour means Business.
- ◆ Basic includes no technical support cases. Wanting to open a case eliminates it, however tight the budget.
- ◆ Shield Advanced still needs Business or Enterprise to reach the Shield Response Team.
- ◆ **Marketplace sells third-party software. Service Catalog lists your own approved products.**

ON THE EXAM

The old four names retire on 1 January 2027. The exam still uses them, and the requirement-to-tier mapping is unchanged.